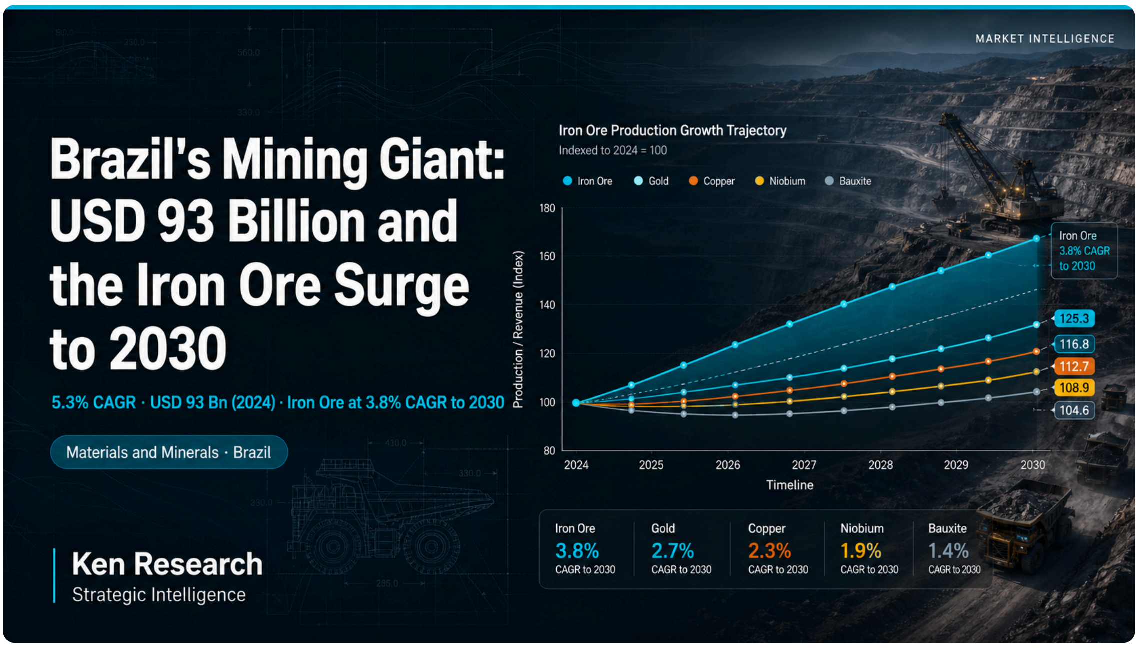

Brazil's Mining Sector Just Hit USD 93 Billion: Ken Research Breaks Down Vale's Iron Ore Lead and the Critical Minerals Race to 2030

Brazil is not just a mining nation: it is a global mineral powerhouse, and the numbers confirm what many investors have been watching from the sidelines. **Ken Research** has published a deep-dive into the **Brazil Mining Market**, revealing that the country's metals and mining industry recorded revenues of **USD 93 billion in 2024**, growing at a **5.3% CAGR between 2019 and 2024**. With iron ore production forecast to expand at a further **3.8% CAGR through 2030**, Brazil's mining sector is not approaching a ceiling: it is building a new floor.

Iron Ore Supremacy: How Vale and Brazil's Para State Anchor Global Supply

Brazil's iron ore story is inseparable from Vale S.A., the world's largest iron ore producer, which anchors both the volume and value of Brazil's extraction economy. The broader **Latin America Mining Market** shows Brazil commanding **32.5% of regional mining revenues in 2024**, a share that reflects the concentration of high-grade iron ore deposits in Minas Gerais and Para states. Global demand for iron ore remains structurally elevated as steel-intensive infrastructure programs accelerate across Asia and the Middle East, and Vale's projected output of **325 to 335 million tons in 2025** underscores how central Brazil is to that supply equation. The **Global Mining Equipment Market** is simultaneously expanding as Brazil's mines invest in automation and efficiency upgrades.

- **Vale S.A.:** World's largest iron ore producer; accounts for the dominant share of Brazil's iron ore export volumes; expanding automation across Para state operations.
- **Minas Gerais and Para:** The two states that anchor Brazil's iron ore and gold production; **17% of global iron ore production** originates from Brazilian mines.
- **CSN (National Steel Company):** Second major iron ore player; vertically integrated from mining through steel production; key exporter to Asian markets.
- **BHP Billiton:** International major with significant Brazilian iron ore assets through the Samarco joint venture with Vale.

Niobium, Gold and Bauxite: Brazil's Hidden Mineral Wealth Beyond Iron Ore

Brazil's mineral story extends far beyond iron ore, into a set of strategic reserves that are increasingly critical to global supply chains. Brazil holds **98% of the world's known niobium reserves**, a metal essential for high-strength steel used in aerospace, automotive, and construction applications. This near-monopoly position gives Brazil extraordinary pricing power in a material that is difficult to substitute. The **Chile Mining Market** and the **Argentina Mining Market** are both competing for lithium and copper leadership in Latin America, but Brazil's niobium dominance is in a category of its own.

- **Niobium:** Brazil holds **98% of global niobium reserves**; CBMM (Companhia Brasileira de Metalurgia e Mineracao) is the world's dominant producer.

- **Gold:** AngloGold Ashanti and Yamana Gold operate major Brazilian gold assets; gold production is concentrated in Minas Gerais and Para states.
- **Bauxite:** Brazil is among the top five global bauxite producers; Norsk Hydro and the Alumar Consortium are major operators; bauxite feeds Brazil's growing alumina refining capacity.
- **Copper and Zinc:** Emerging production areas in the Amazon basin are attracting new exploration investment as global copper demand surges with electrification trends.

Want to see Ken Research's full breakdown of Brazil's mining segments, company market shares, and production forecasts through 2030? **Download Sample Report** and access the complete competitive landscape and regional analysis.

Why Is Brazil's Iron Ore Production Growing at 3.8% CAGR Despite Global Headwinds?

The 3.8% CAGR for Brazilian iron ore through 2030 surprises many observers given the softness in Chinese steel demand in 2023 and 2024. Ken Research's analysis points to three structural factors sustaining the growth trajectory. First, infrastructure-led demand from Southeast Asia, the Middle East, and Africa is absorbing iron ore volumes that China once monopolized. Second, Brazil's iron ore quality premium over Australian alternatives is widening as grade specifications tighten. Third, the **Global Underground Mining Market** is expanding as Brazil's surface deposits mature and operators invest in deeper, higher-grade underground extraction systems.

Critical Minerals and the 2030 Frontier: Copper, Lithium and Brazil's Strategic Edge

Brazil's next mining chapter is being written in critical minerals. Copper exploration in the Amazon and Cerrado regions is attracting investment from major global miners as the energy transition drives structural demand growth. Brazil's geological surveys estimate copper reserves that could support decades of production expansion, yet remain largely undeveloped. Ken Research's data shows that the government's **National Mining Plan and royalty reform frameworks** are actively designed to accelerate critical mineral extraction. The broader context of the

Global Mining Metals Market shows that investors are reassessing Brazil's critical mineral potential as the country's regulatory environment improves for foreign mining operators.

- **Copper Frontier:** New exploration zones in the Amazon basin and Carajas mineral province are attracting investment from Vale, Anglo American, and junior explorers.
- **Lithium:** Brazil's Jequitinhonha Valley in Minas Gerais holds some of South America's largest lithium deposits outside Bolivia and Argentina; development-stage projects are accelerating.
- **National Mining Plan: Government royalty reform and streamlined permitting** are reducing the time-to-production for new mining projects, lowering investment risk.
- **ESG Compliance:** International mining majors are prioritizing Brazil for its relatively advanced environmental monitoring frameworks compared to other emerging market mining jurisdictions.

Brazil's critical minerals window is open and the competitive positioning is still being determined across iron ore, niobium, copper and lithium. **View the Brazil Mining Market Report** to access Ken Research's full analysis of production forecasts, player strategies, and investment trajectories through 2030.

Conclusion

Brazil's mining sector at **USD 93 billion in 2024** is neither a mature plateau nor a speculative bet: it is a structurally growing market with multiple expansion vectors running simultaneously. The **5.3% historical CAGR** and the **3.8% iron ore production growth forecast** tell only part of the story. The niobium monopoly, the emerging critical minerals frontier, and Vale's continued scale expansion position Brazil as an indispensable node in global mineral supply chains for the next decade. Ken Research's intelligence makes clear that **the race to secure critical mineral access is accelerating**, and Brazil is at its center. Access the complete **Brazil Mining Market** report to get Ken Research's full competitive and investment framework.

Frequently Asked Questions

What is the size of Brazil's mining market in 2024?

Brazil's metals and mining industry recorded revenues of USD 93 billion in 2024, growing at a 5.3% CAGR between 2019 and 2024. Brazil accounts for 32.5% of Latin America's total mining market revenues, making it the dominant regional mining economy.

Which countries compete with Brazil in Latin American mining?

Chile leads in copper production, while Peru is a major silver and gold producer. Argentina is emerging in lithium. For a regional perspective across all these markets, the **Latin America Mining Market** report from Ken Research provides a comprehensive competitive comparison across Brazil, Chile, Mexico, Peru, and Argentina.

What minerals does Brazil produce beyond iron ore?

Brazil produces bauxite, gold, copper, niobium, lead, tin, zinc, and manganese. Its most strategically unique holding is niobium, where it controls 98% of global known reserves. The **Global Mining Metals Market** report provides context on how Brazil's mineral mix positions it within global supply chains.

Who are the major mining companies operating in Brazil?

Vale S.A. is the dominant player and world's largest iron ore producer. Other major operators include AngloGold Ashanti, BHP Billiton (Samarco JV), CSN, Yamana Gold, and Norsk Hydro for bauxite. CBMM holds a near-global monopoly on niobium production through its Araxa operations in Minas Gerais.

What is Brazil's iron ore production forecast through 2030?

Brazil's iron ore production is forecast to grow at a 3.8% CAGR through 2030. Vale alone expects to produce 325 to 335 million tons in 2025, continuing its trajectory as the world's primary high-grade iron ore supplier to Asian and European steel markets.